

OFFICIAL NEWSLETTER

Welcome to the Arike Palliative Home Care Bulletin!

Within these pages, we share the stories and highlights of our work, emphasizing the difference it makes in the community. Your continued support helps us move forward and reach more people in need. Thank you for being with us on this journey.

Restoring Comfort Through Compassionate Care

Every person carries a skill that can ease someone else's burden. The Arike team recently received a call from the family of a bedbound person living with Spinal Muscular Atrophy (SMA). His fingernails and toenails had not been trimmed for several months. An earlier attempt had resulted in an accidental cut and bleeding, leaving the family understandably worried about trying again. They were looking for someone who could help safely and professionally.

The team immediately thought of a conversation that had taken place several months earlier. During a visit to Arike, Dr. Sunil Kumar from IMA Cochin had mentioned that his wife, Padmaja, was a professional beautician who wanted to use her free time to support people who were unable to leave their homes and needed assistance with personal grooming. When the Arike team reached out to Padmaja, she readily agreed to help.



Mrs. Padmaja Sunilkumar provides professional grooming care at home.

She then visited the patient at home and provided attentive, professional care. With patience and precision, she carefully trimmed, shaped and cleaned his fingernails and toenails, taking every precaution to ensure that he experienced no discomfort. But her visit did not end with grooming. She spent time with the patient and his family, listening to their concerns and offering practical advice and guidance. Her willingness to stay, listen and engage with them brought an added sense of reassurance and support to the family.

For the patient, it was a small but meaningful restoration of comfort. For his family, it brought relief after months of worry and hesitation. But Padmaja saw the experience as something more than simply providing a grooming service.

"I'm always happy to step in when I have time during the day. It's a wonderful feeling knowing a simple skill can bring someone real relief. I just hope that by sharing this, others feel inspired to step forward and do the same."



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Her words capture something at the heart of palliative care: care is not limited to medicines, procedures or clinical interventions. A beautician's skill, offered at the right moment, became a source of comfort. A simple act of grooming, accompanied by her time, attention and guidance, helped restore a sense of normalcy and dignity to someone living with significant physical limitations.

There are many people in our communities who have skills, time and a willingness to help. Sometimes, all that is needed is an opportunity to put those skills to meaningful use. Padmaja's gentle gesture reminds us that every skill has the potential to become an act of care—and every act of care can help someone live with greater comfort, dignity and ease.

Volunteer Diaries

This was my first experience in palliative care, and it really touched me. I realized that even in a small area, there are many people who need care, support, and simply someone to be there for them. It made me understand that palliative care is something that can touch everyone's life at some point and is something we need to develop further across Kerala. This experience has inspired me to learn more and contribute wherever I can. I wish Arike's initiatives all the best and hope they continue to reach and support many more people.

– Nafeesath

ACTIVITIES

On August 7, 2026, Arike marked its 7th anniversary, celebrating seven years of commitment to community-based palliative care and compassionate support. The occasion brought together members, volunteers, supporters, and well-wishers to reflect on Arike's journey and its continued efforts to support individuals and families living with serious illnesses.



Arike's 7th anniversary celebration



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Edappally Zone Meeting

On August 9, 2026, the Edappally Zone Meeting was held at Vaduthala. The meeting provided an opportunity for team members and volunteers to review ongoing activities, discuss local initiatives, and strengthen coordination for community-based palliative care efforts in the zone.



Edappally Zone team meeting at Vaduthala.

IMA General Body Meeting – Onam Kit Campaign

On August 19, 2026, Arike conducted a fundraising campaign for the Onam Kit initiative during the Indian Medical Association (IMA) General Body Meeting. The campaign focused on supporting families and individuals in need during the Onam season by providing food kits.



Onam Kit fundraising campaign at the IMA



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IMA-Arike Onam Celebration

On August 21, 2026, IMA and Arike organized an Onam celebration, bringing together volunteers, supporters, and contributors. The celebration included making a traditional Pookalam, an Onasadya, and fun games, creating an opportunity for the Arike community to come together and celebrate the spirit of Onam.



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IMA-Arike Onam celebration



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Onam Kit Distribution

On August 23, 2026, Arike conducted the distribution of Onam food kits to families in need. The kits were distributed by Dr. Geetha, Arun, Donal, and volunteers. A total of 21 food kits were distributed as part of the initiative, extending support to beneficiaries during the Onam season.



Distribution of Onam food kits to families at their homes

Sensitization Programme at Dr. Palppu Kudumba Unit

On August 30, 2026, Arike conducted a sensitization programme at the Dr. Palppu Kudumba Unit of the SNDP Shakha at Vyttila. Mr. Suhail and Mr. Donal led the session, introducing participants to the importance of community-based palliative care and encouraging greater community involvement in supporting people living with serious illnesses.

Care Info

Helping the Patient Stay Hydrated

Adequate fluids help prevent dehydration and improve the patient's comfort and well-being.

- Offer small amounts of water or other preferred fluids frequently, rather than giving a large quantity at once.
- Encourage the patient to drink whenever they are comfortable and able to do so.
- Keep a cup or bottle of water within easy reach of the patient.
- Offer fluids that the patient enjoys, according to their preferences and care team's advice.
- Watch for signs of dehydration such as a dry mouth, reduced urine, dark urine, or unusual weakness.
- If the patient has difficulty swallowing, do not force fluids. Inform the care team for appropriate advice.
- Keep the patient's lips and mouth moist to improve comfort, especially when they are drinking less.
- Contact the care team if the patient is unable to drink, has persistent vomiting, or shows signs of significant dehydration.



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A Heartfelt Thank You

At Arike, every act of kindness becomes a source of strength for the patients and families we serve. We extend our deepest gratitude to all our supporters whose generosity, trust, and encouragement continue to uplift our mission. Your contributions—big and small—help us deliver dignified, compassionate care to those facing serious health-related suffering.

Help Us Drive Independence Contribute now & empower a ride



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Vehicle with wheelchair access available for travel



Wheelchair users deserve barrier-free travel at zero cost. Support our operational expenses and make every journey possible.

Support Our Cause

With your support, Arike is able to provide free home-based palliative care services to patients within the Kochi Corporation limits. On average, our team cares for 40 patients every day, ensuring that they receive compassionate and holistic support in the comfort of their homes. Nearly ₹10 lakh is required every month to sustain these services. However, this amount itself is insufficient to meet the growing needs of patients and extend our services to more families in need.

Palliative care is not limited to managing physical symptoms alone. We also support patients and families through medicines, nutritional support, and assistance for the educational needs of children. We invite you to become a monthly supporter with a minimum contribution of ₹500 per month.



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